

So I mostly wrote this out, continuing as if the game is like a city builder / tycoon which it may not be but I tried to stay consistent all the way though so its not just my thoughts scattered in all directions.

I tried to keep everything with the design of addiction and incentive so you feel like you have an incentive to keep going and keep coming back

I also have the fairies as a population instead of individual characters so we don't have to spend so much time working out the assets / designs/ individual traits and abilities for unique collectability. I think that would be a massive undertaking.

So what's our map and what's our incentive / objective. - filling the forest with fairies.

The idea I ended up with and will explain more as i go contains 3 (because 3 is honestly plenty for us) forest sections. You need to unlock a structure that feels like a trophy achievement and something to work towards

I think you should be combating something but not a literal enemy profile just the dark or withered forest itself. So the forest the map is a dark black forest until its revival 3 sections You are given the first one at the start and the koi pond is revived. And that gives you your starter space. So you are healing the forest as you progress.

Each of the three "legendary structures" will have its own quest line; this is how you obtain items or artifacts that are used to unlock / revive the next area. It could simply send an expedition random results until all artifacts are obtained or however whatever.

I think sticking with the mystical theme the second unlock should be a portal ruin or something like that a stone circular structure and even makes the quest line make a bit more sense go through portal to fetch, maybe each structure is a portal by unique design, the koi pond is a portal with a unique design?

In the unlocked areas if IF its a population tycoon aiming to have more and more fairies populate they will need 2 things- housing and food

So you can focus on building farms as structures and upgrade the levels you wouldn't necessarily need to collect the good just the levels would need to match the population for "sustainability"

And the housing can be mushroom huts with variety you have a number of smaller huts unlock a few medium adna large or 2 instead of upgrading homes but its a matter of having them all eventually placed.

And to build homes. You'll need building materials. I know we said gems but gems to me make it sound like items are being purchased and if that's what we want it's fine. Maybe we could say

crystals instead. And items like this would be collection based so you have to reopen after a certain amount of time and manually collect.

I think a building material like this would be great to use a forge as a structure. Which again you can upgrade the forge more and more to collect at higher rates.

I think the potion shop is also a great material but it doesn't NEED to be a minigame with this setup. It simply makes elixirs as a material for collections and again keeps upgrading the potion shop.

The upgrades can be made from the opposing material AND perhaps a quest item from the portal.

So once you've built all the population huts that need to have been made. (farms to accommodate), gathered enough crystals and elixirs, and completed the collection needed for the next unlock

You spend and revive the next area of the forest. Giving you a whole new space to work with. I think the second should be a portal ruin because its fitting, doesn't really matter.

Additionally after reviving an area even the beginner one there may be debris or something that needs fixing / clearing so you don't just jump right into placing wherever you have to clear some I dont know withered debris branches rocks etc to give you the space to place the structures.

The last and final area being the tree of life (most rewarding) and you repeat around that area. MAYBE and I know this is not what you do for a normal tycoon city builder meant to have no end complete a quest line and the tree would have an quick animation of reviving the whole forrest a beat the game kinda deal absolutely not needed but because the areas don't go on forever just something I thought out loud. Even without a fourth area if we use the quest system also for upgrading structures then having a quest portal in the third section still fits it can be at the base of the tree in the roots (idea for the design)

I'm sure I left some things out writing this feel free to say whatever. This may not even be close to the game you guys want, but I think it's consistent, doesn't require a lot of complex mechanics, a simple progression easy to follow, no complex storytelling. No individual fairy assets.

I did not turn structures into minigames so we wouldn't be making several games inside of one, but if that's something you guys want to do we can work it out for sure.

Im curious to hear what you guys think about this approach